

ENGLISH

GRAMMAR

CLAUSES

Lecture - 1

CLAUSES

Clauses are a group of words - consisting of SUBJECT and VERB

Eg: The boy sat on the chair ----- BOY (Subject) and SAT (Verb)

Eg: Leo barked at the boy ----- LEO (Subject) and BARKED (Verb)

Can we say a clause is a sentence?? ✓

YES we can. A complete clause which provides a clear meaning (with at least one independent clause) can be termed as a complete sentence.

TYPES OF CLAUSE

There are 2 main types of clause :

INDEPENDENT CLAUSE

- Consists of Subject and a verb
- CAN stand as an independent sentence
- Meaningful and makes sense
- Eg: She looks all puffed up
He studied all night long

DEPENDENT CLAUSE *OR* /SUBORDINATE CLAUSE

- Consists of Subject and a verb
- CAN NOT stand as an independent sentence
- Doesnt have any meaning-needs an independent clause as support
- Eg: as she slept for long
? even when he was tired

TYPES OF CLAUSE

Generally, Dependent clause begins with a word called a **dependent marker**.

This dependent marker can be either

- a subordinating conjunction (e.g., "because," "before," "unless") *as*
- or a relative pronoun (e.g., "that," "which," "who")
- *types*

Dependent clauses can act as either of these in sentences:

1. an adverb *clause*
2. an adjective *clause*
3. a noun *clause*.

We will be mainly focusing on these 3 types of dependent clauses.

ADVERB CLAUSE

It is a type of dependent clause that

- acts as an adverb in a sentence
- by modifying a verb, an adjective, or another adverb.
- It often answers questions such as when, where, why, how, or under what conditions

Examples:

- I stayed at home because it was raining.
- ☞ Adverb clause of reason (Why?)
 - She sings as if she were a professional singer.
- ☞ Adverb clause of manner (How?)
 - You can go out to play after you finish your homework.
- ☞ Adverb clause of time (When?)
 - If you study hard, you will pass the exam.
- ☞ Adverb clause of condition (Under what condition?)

ad → ①

adverb clause → ② or more

ADVERB CLAUSE

IF the adverbial clause comes before the independent clause, it must be followed by a comma.

Eg:

- ^{AC.} When the movie ended, ^{IC.} we went out for dinner. ^{when.}
- Since you arrived early, we can start the meeting now.

IF the adverbial clause follows the independent clause, no comma is needed

Eg:

- We went out for dinner when the movie ended.
- They continued their hike although it was raining

ADVERB CLAUSE: TYPES

- Adverb Clause of Time

Example: I'll call you when I reach home. – Tells when the action will happen.

- Adverb Clause of Place

Example: You can sit wherever you like. – Tells where the action happens.

- Adverb Clause of Reason (Cause)

Example: She left early because she was tired. – Explains why something happened

- Adverb Clause of Condition

Example: If it rains, we'll stay inside. – Tells the condition under which something happens.

ADVERB CLAUSE: TYPES

- Adverb Clause of Purpose

Example: He studies hard so that he can succeed. – Tells the purpose of an action.

- Adverb Clause of Manner

Example: She dances as if she were a professional. – Describes how the action is done.

- Adverb Clause of Comparison

Example: He works as hard as his brother does. – Compares actions or qualities.

- Adverb Clause of Concession (Contrast)

Example: Although he was tired, he continued working. – Shows contrast to the main clause.

AC.

IC.

ADJECTIVE CLAUSE

also called a relative clause It is a type of dependent clause that

- acts as an adjective in a sentence to give more information about a noun or pronoun.
- adjective clause can't be placed at the beginning of a sentence - it must follow the noun or pronoun it describes.

Examples:

The ^{Adi} (tall) boy is my cousin

- The boy who won the race is my cousin.

☞ Adjective clause modifying "boy"

- I have a book that explains quantum physics.

☞ Adjective clause modifying "book"

- The teacher whom we met yesterday is very kind.

☞ Adjective clause modifying "teacher"

- She wore a dress which sparkled under the lights.

☞ Adjective clause modifying "dress"

ADJECTIVE CLAUSE

The use of commas in adjective clause depends upon the meaning of the sentence.

Commas are needed for clauses which provide nonessential information
(e.g., "I am going to Dresden, which is in Germany").

Commas are not needed for clauses which provide essential information
(e.g., "Book the flight that has the fewest stops").

NOUN CLAUSE

It is a dependent clause that

- acts as a noun in a sentence.
- can serve as a subject or an object.
- Just like a noun can be a person, place, thing, or idea--- A noun clause does the job of a noun: it can be a subject, object, or complement in a sentence
- Noun clauses often start with words like:

that, what, whatever, who, whoever, whom, why, when, where, how

Examples:

- What you said made me smile.
→ (It acts as the subject. What made me smile? "What you said.")
- I don't know where she went.
→ (It acts as the object. I don't know what? "Where she went.")
- The problem is that we are late.
→ (It completes the sentence. What is the problem? "That we are late.")

NOUN CLAUSE

- What he did was unexpected.
- ☞ Noun clause as subject — it's the "thing" that was unexpected.
 - She couldn't understand why they were laughing.
- ☞ Noun clause as object — it's what she couldn't understand.
 - The winner will be whoever finishes first.
- ☞ Noun clause as subject complement — it tells who the winner will be.
 - He forgot that today was the deadline.
- ☞ Noun clause as object — it's what he forgot.
 - They are discussing whether we should cancel the trip.
- ☞ Noun clause as object of the verb "discussing."

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